

CHARLES E. EESLEY

Professor, Department of Management Science & Engineering, Stanford University
W.M. Keck Foundation Faculty Scholar
Co-Director for International Entrepreneurship, Stanford Technology Ventures Program (STVP)

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RESEARCH SUMMARY

Eesley studies how institutional environments, industrial policy, export controls, and platform design shape who becomes a technology founder and what they build. A core methodological contribution is the large-scale alumni-entrepreneur survey, developed with Edward B. Roberts at MIT and extended with William F. Miller at Stanford, which established the empirical basis for measuring the economic impact of research universities and has since been adopted at MIT, Stanford, UVA, Tsinghua, and other institutions. A parallel program builds and evaluates engineering entrepreneurship education at scale, from Stanford's E145 (its project track now re-anchored on the NAE Grand Challenges for Engineering) to MOOC and accelerator field experiments reaching more than 200,000 learners. Methods span quasi-experimental causal inference and LLM-based analysis of regulatory and policy corpora.

EDUCATION

- **Ph.D., Management.** MIT Sloan School of Management, 2009. Advisor: Edward B. Roberts (1935–2024).
- **B.S., Cognitive Neuroscience.** Duke University, 2002.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- **Professor (full).** Department of Management Science & Engineering, Stanford University, 2025–present.
- **Associate Professor (with tenure).** Management Science & Engineering, Stanford University, 2017–2025.
- **Assistant Professor.** Management Science & Engineering, Stanford University, 2009–2017 (reappointed 2013; on leave Oct 2013–Sep 2014).
- **W.M. Keck Foundation Faculty Scholar.** Stanford University, 2017–present.

NATIONAL & GOVERNMENT SERVICE

- National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine. Participant and presenter, Government-University-Industry-Philanthropy Research Roundtable (GUIPRR) workshop on the macroeconomics of research investment, Washington, DC, April 2026.
- Congressional briefing, U.S. Joint Economic Committee. Industrial policy and U.S.–China technology competition.
- National Science Foundation. Advisor, “Enhancing NSF’s Impact on STEM Translation and Commercialization Success” (Award #2337688), 2023–2026.
- National Science Foundation. I-Corps Pre- and Post-Program “Train the Trainer,” 2023–2026.
- National Science Foundation. Reviewer, I-Corps Special Project, Directorate for Technology, Innovation, and Partnerships, 2024.
- National Science Foundation. Grant Review Panel, Future of Work at the Human-Technology Frontier, 2020.
- U.S. Department of State. Board member and curriculum lead, Global Innovation through Science & Technology (GIST) Network, reaching youth in 130+ low- and middle-income countries, 2013–2017. Judge, GIST Tech-I finals, Global Entrepreneurship Summit, Nairobi, 2015.

HONORS & AWARDS

- Stanford Social Impact Labs Design Fellowship, 2024.
- Top-cited article (past two years), Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal, 2023.
- Stanford Teagle Fellow in Liberal Education, 2021–2023.
- IACMR–RRBM Responsible Research in Management Award, 2020.
- Institute for Advanced Study Visiting Fellowship, Technical University of Munich, 2019.
- Finalist, Best Organization & Management Theory (OMT) Published Paper, 2018.
- Industry Studies Association Giarratani Rising Star Award (Runner-Up), 2018.
- TUM Research Excellence Award, Technical University of Munich, 2018.

- W.M. Keck Foundation Faculty Scholar Award, 2017.
- Stanford MS&E Undergraduate Teaching Award, 2017.
- Richard Schulze Inaugural Distinguished Professorship Award, 2015.
- Kauffman-Nesta Research Grant (RCTs in Entrepreneurship), 2014.
- Best Paper Award, IEEE Recent Advances in Technology & Innovation Management, 2012.
- Batten Institute Fellow, University of Virginia Darden School of Business, 2012.
- NSFC Research Fund for International Young Scientists, 2012.
- Best Dissertation Award (Business Policy & Strategy Division), Academy of Management, 2009.
- Kauffman Foundation Dissertation Fellowship, 2009.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- Co-Director for International Entrepreneurship, Stanford Technology Ventures Program (STVP), 2024–present (Associate Faculty Director for International Entrepreneurship, 2023–2024).
- Academic Director, ITRI-Stanford Platform (Advancing Technology Ventures), in collaboration with Taiwan's DOIT and Ministry of Economic Affairs, 2013–present.
- Academic Director, Aramco Lab7 Advancing Technology Ventures, Stanford Center for Global & Online Education, 2025–present.
- Academic Director, KFUPM Founders Track, Dhahran Techno Valley × King Fahd University of Petroleum & Minerals.
- Faculty Director, Stanford BOSP Shenzhen Global Seminar, August 2026.
- Chair, Pathways to Research & Opportunity (PRO) Committee, Stanford MS&E, 2020–present.
- Steering Committee, Stanford King Center on Global Development, 2024–present.
- Faculty Advisor, Business Association of Stanford Entrepreneurial Students (BASES), 2018–present.
- Editorial Board, Strategic Management Journal (2014–present) and Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal (2021–present).
- Advisor, United Nations World Food Programme accelerator review, 2024–2025.
- Advisory Board, Chile's Ministry of the Economy (CORFO), Start-Up Chile, 2012–2017; AAAS GIST Tech-I, 2012–2017.

TEACHING: A THREE-LEVEL ENGINEERING ENTREPRENEURSHIP PROGRAM

- E145 Technology Entrepreneurship (undergraduate). Taught since 2009; project track re-anchored on the NAE Grand Challenges for Engineering.
- MS&E 272 Entrepreneurship Without Borders (graduate). Co-taught with Vimbayi Kajese; recently redesigned to treat agentic AI as a first-class subject of study.
- MS&E 379 Causal Inference for Entrepreneurship Research (Ph.D.).
- MS&E 372 Doctoral Seminar on Entrepreneurship & Inequality (Ph.D.).
- E145 / NovoEd MOOC pipeline reached 200,000+ learners worldwide and validated the cohort-based online-learning model later acquired by Devonshire Investors / Fidelity.

DOCTORAL ADVISING & PLACEMENT

Nine of eleven former doctoral students hold tenure-track faculty positions, at institutions including Columbia, Oxford Saïd, Carnegie Mellon Tepper, Johns Hopkins Carey, NUS, CUHK Business School, the University of Oregon Lundquist, and Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile.

Current

- Yikai Cao; Zahra Hejrati (co-advised with Kathleen Eisenhardt); Xilan Zhang; Wajeeha Ahmad (co-advised with Erik Brynjolfsson; defended 2026).

Former (selected)

- Daniel Armanios, Robert Eberhart, Khonika Gope, Wesley Koo, Michael Leatherbee, Jamber Li, Carrington Motley, Tyler Whittle, You (Willow) Wu.

REFEREED JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Author order signifies contribution. Bolded names denote current or former doctoral students.

1. Eesley, C.; Gerber, E. 2025. Designing Institutions for Applied Impact: Lessons from Engineering for Organizational Research. *Organization Science*, 36(5): 2044–2051.

2. **Koo, W.**; Eesley, C. 2025. Take Me Home, Country Roads: Return Migration and Platform-Enabled Entrepreneurship. *Organization Science*, 36(3): 1202–1220.
3. Eesley, C.; Tian, X.; Yang, D.; Lee, Y.S. 2025. University Education Reform and Entrepreneurship. *Management and Organization Review*, 1–31.
4. **Ahmad, W.**; Sen, A.; Eesley, C.; Brynjolfsson, E. 2024. Companies Inadvertently Fund Online Misinformation Despite Consumer Backlash. *Nature*, 630(8015): 123–131.
5. **Motley, C.**; Eesley, C.; **Koo, W.** 2023. Born Into Chaos: How Founding Conditions Shape Whether Ventures Survive or Thrive When Experiencing Environmental Change. *Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal*, 17(2): 408–444.
6. Eesley, C.; Lee, Y.S. 2023. In Institutions We Trust? Trust in Government and the Allocation of Entrepreneurial Intentions. *Organization Science*, 34(2): 532–556.
7. **Wu, Y.**; Eesley, C.E.; Yang, D. 2022. Entrepreneurial Strategies During Institutional Changes: Evidence from China's Economic Transition. *Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal*, 16(1): 185–206.
8. **Armanios, D.**; Eesley, C. 2021. Lowering Entry Barriers (but also Providing Resources): How Governments Spur Founding. *Organization Science*, 32(6): 1415–1438.
9. **Wu, Y.**; Eesley, C.E. 2021. Regional Migration, Entrepreneurship and University Alumni. *Regional Studies*, 56(6): 1–18.
10. **Li, Z.**; Seering, W.; Yang, M.; Eesley, C. 2021. Understanding the Motivations for Open-Source Hardware Entrepreneurship. *Design Science*, 7: e19.
11. Lee, Y.S.; Eesley, C. 2021. Do University Entrepreneurship Programs Promote Entrepreneurship? *Strategic Management Journal*, 42(4): 833–861.
12. **Koo, W.**; Eesley, C. 2020. Platform Governance and the Rural–Urban Divide: Sellers' Responses to Design Change. *Strategic Management Journal*, 42(5): 941–967.
13. Eesley, C.; Wu, L. 2020. For Startups, Adaptability and Mentor Network Diversity Can Be Pivotal: Evidence from a Randomized Experiment on a MOOC Platform. *MIS Quarterly*, 44(2): 661–697.
14. **Wu, Y.**; Eesley, C.E.; Eisenhardt, K.M. 2020. Entrepreneurship in Dynamic Environments: A Comparison Between the U.S. and China. *Quarterly Journal of Management*, 5(2): 1–17.
15. **Eberhart, R.N.**; Eesley, C.E. 2018. Too Much of a Good Thing: Institutional Change and New Firm Performance in Japan. *Strategic Management Journal*, 39(10): 2643–2665.
16. Lee, Y.S.; Eesley, C.E. 2018. The Persistence of Entrepreneurship and Innovative Immigrants. *Research Policy*, 47(6): 1032–1044.
17. Eesley, C.E.; **Eberhart, R.N.**; Skousen, B.R.; Cheng, J.L. 2018. Institutions and Entrepreneurial Activity: The Interactive Influence of Misaligned Formal and Informal Institutions. *Strategy Science*, 3(2): 393–407.
18. Eesley, C.; Wang, Y. 2017. Social Influence in Entrepreneurial Career Choice: Evidence from Randomized Field Experiments on Entrepreneurial Mentorship. *Research Policy*, 46(3): 636–650.
19. **Eberhart, R.**; Eesley, C.; Eisenhardt, K.M. 2017. Failure Is an Option: Institutional Barriers to Failure, Bankruptcy, and New Firm Performance in Japan. *Organization Science*, 28(1): 93–112.
20. **Armanios, D.**; Eesley, C.; **Li, J.**; Eisenhardt, K.M. 2017. How Entrepreneurs Leverage Institutional Intermediaries in Emerging Economies to Acquire Public Resources. *Strategic Management Journal* (lead article), 38(7): 1373–1390.
21. Eesley, C. 2016. Institutional Barriers to Growth: Entrepreneurship, Human Capital and Institutional Change. *Organization Science*, 27(5): 1290–1306.
22. Eesley, C.; **Li, J.B.**; Yang, D. 2016. Does Institutional Change in Universities Influence High-Tech Entrepreneurship? Evidence from China's Project 985. *Organization Science*, 27(2): 446–461.
23. Eesley, C.; DeCelles, K.; Lenox, M. 2016. Through the Mud or in the Boardroom: Activist Types and Their Strategies in Targeting Firms for Social Change. *Strategic Management Journal*, 37(12): 2425–2440.
24. Eesley, C.; Hsu, D.; Roberts, E.B. 2014. The Contingent Effects of Top Management Teams on Venture Performance: Aligning Founding Team Composition with Innovation Strategy and Commercialization Environment. *Strategic Management Journal*, 35(12): 1798–1817.
25. Eesley, C.; Roberts, E.B. 2012. Are You Experienced? When Does Talent vs. Experience Drive Entrepreneurial Performance. *Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal*, 6(3): 207–219.
26. Lenox, M.; Eesley, C. 2009. Private Environmental Activism and the Selection and Response of Firm Targets. *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*, 18(1): 45–73.
27. Hsu, D.H.; Roberts, E.B.; Eesley, C. 2007. Entrepreneurs from Technology-Based Universities. *Research Policy*, 36: 768–788.
28. Eesley, C.; Lenox, M. 2006. Firm Responses to Secondary Stakeholder Action. *Strategic Management Journal*, 27(8): 765–781.

29. Keefe, R.; Eesley, C.E.; Poe, M. 2005. Defining a Cognitive Function Decrement in Schizophrenia. *Biological Psychiatry*, 57: 688–691.

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

An active program on industrial policy, export controls, and venture capital allocation.

- When External Shocks Attract Capital: Export Controls and Venture Capital Allocation in China (with Yikai Cao, Wanru Deng, Guankai Zhai). Quasi-experimental evidence that U.S. semiconductor export controls increased VC funding to targeted Chinese startups.
- Industrial Policy Reshapes Venture Capital Allocation in Climate Technologies (with Yikai Cao, Rishee Jain, Dinesh Moorjani). Introduces a Policy Credibility Index; in preparation for PNAS.
- Subsidy Design Without Capability Screening: Entry Composition in China's Battery Sector (with Guankai Zhai). In preparation for Research Policy.
- CHIPS Act and U.S. Semiconductor Entrepreneurship (with JungYun Han). Under revision.
- Founding-Process Pathways (with Zahra Hejrati, Clough, and Vissa). Under review.
- Learning-by-Advising? Startup Learning as an Advice-Giver in Accelerators (with Zhuoxuan (Fanny) Li, JungYun Han). Randomized field experiment in a Thai online accelerator.

SELECTED BOOKS, CHAPTERS & IMPACT REPORTS

- Eesley, C.E.; Miller, W.F. 2018. Impact: Stanford University's Economic Impact via Innovation and Entrepreneurship. *Foundations and Trends in Entrepreneurship*, 14(2): 130–278.
- Roberts, E.B.; Eesley, C. 2009. *Entrepreneurial Impact: The Role of MIT*. Kauffman Foundation.
- King, A.; Lenox, M.; Eesley, C.; Mehedi, A. 2014. The Economic Impact of Entrepreneurial Alumni: A Case Study of the University of Virginia. *Batten Briefing Series*, UVA Darden.
- Eesley, C.; Yang, D.; Roberts, E.B.; Li, T. 2016. Understanding Entrepreneurial Process and Performance: A Cross-National Comparison of Alumni Entrepreneurship Between MIT and Tsinghua University. *Asian Journal of Innovation and Policy*, 5(2): 146–184.
- Eesley, C.; Zhou, L.; **Wu, Y.** 2021. Fostering Entrepreneurship and Innovation: Education, Human Capital, and the Institutional Environment. In Lee & Yan (eds.), *Drivers of Innovation*. Stanford Shorenstein APARC.

SELECTED INVITED & KEYNOTE LECTURES

- National Academies Government-University-Industry-Philanthropy Research Roundtable (GUIPRR) workshop, Washington, DC, April 2026.
- Congressional briefing, U.S. Joint Economic Committee, on industrial policy and U.S.–China technology competition.
- Nanyang Technological University, Singapore, January 2026.
- UNLV Troesh Research Conference, 2026.
- Stanford Engineering, The Future of Everything (podcast with Russ Altman), February 2026.
- Keynote, 28th Taiwan Symposium on Innovation Economics & Entrepreneurship, Taipei, 2023.
- Keynote, 3rd International Symposium on Corporate Acceleration, London, 2022.
- Keynote, World Youth Entrepreneurship Summit, Zhejiang University, Hangzhou, 2022.
- Keynote, Third International Conference of Entrepreneurship Research, EGADE / Tec de Monterrey, 2020.
- Keynote, National Taiwan University, University-Industry Partnerships, 2019.
- Keynote, CSMOT 25th Anniversary Conference, Hsinchu, Taiwan, 2015.
- Keynote, University of São Paulo, Brazil, University-Industry Partnerships: MIT and Stanford, 2012.

TRANSLATION TO PRACTICE: BOARDS, VENTURES & FOUNDER ROLES

- Co-Founder, NovoEd. Online learning platform spun out of Stanford research; acquired by Devonshire Investors / Fidelity.
- Independent Non-Executive Director and Remuneration Committee Chair, Vobile Group (HKEX: 3738), 2018–present.
- Venture Partner and LP, Brave Capital; active early-stage angel investor.
- Advisor, Nexa AI (on-device multimodal AI), acquired by Qualcomm, 2026.
- Co-Founder, Zhou & Eesley Family Foundation (computer-science and entrepreneurship education for underserved communities).